

Prefrontal

The executive-function assistant that learns how *you* actually work.

Self-hosted · local-first
Runs on your network, always on
Open source (MIT) · live & in daily use

Most productivity tools assume you'll remember to use them.

Prefrontal doesn't. It watches your context — location, calendar, time of day, recent activity — decides on its own when to speak up, and nudges through the channel you'll actually notice. Then it learns from whether the nudge *worked*. **It gets better the longer you use it.**

🧠 Learns from what worked

Not another to-do list — a model of you.

👉 One tap, or it fails

If logging is harder than ignoring, it's useless.

🔒 Your data stays home

Nothing leaves your network unless you say so.

✓ WHAT IT DOES TODAY — LIVE, WITH A CONCRETE EXAMPLE

🕒 Departure reminders

"2:14 — leave in 6 min for the 2:45 dentist. Traffic's heavy."

Factors in real traffic, then escalates **push** → **sound** → **phone call** until you answer. **On time, no nagging.**

🔔 Nudges that decide themselves

It picks the moment, the words, and the channel — and you tap "Wrap up" or "I'm back" right from the lock screen.

A coaching engine, quiet hours and all. **A coach, not an alarm clock.**

🔥 Panic mode

Frozen? One tap → what's actually on fire, what to ignore, and one 5-minute first step.

Just where to put your hands next — not the whole plan. **Breaks the freeze.**

🎯 Hyperfocus guard

Three hours down a rabbit hole? A gentle check. Deep in the right thing? It shields you from every other ping.

Protects good focus, interrupts the costly kind.

✅ The right task, right now

"20 min free at 4pm — knock out 'call the pharmacy.'" Short, low-energy, and the thing you keep dodging.

Matches effort to your energy and the clock. **Not a guilt-list.**

💬 Edit your day in plain English

"Bump the dentist call to urgent and drop the dry cleaning." — Done.

Type it how you'd say it; it previews, you confirm. **No forms.**

ALSO LIVE → Mail triaged to a short action list

Morning briefing

Bad-day recovery mode

One-tap lock-screen replies (ntfy)

Multiple users, each learns on their own

It quietly learns →

your **real** departure lag, **which reminders you ignore after 3pm**, when you tend to go quiet, how much you underestimate time — and tunes its timing, wording, and channel to **you**. Miss a reminder? That's data too.

→ WHERE IT'S GOING NEXT

→ **Context Packs.** Role-based bundles — *Parent, Caregiver, New job* — that pre-wire the primitives for a whole life situation.

→ **One intake for everything.** Mail, a calendar change, a quick thought — captured, sorted, and routed the same way.

→ **First-class delivery.** Native Pushover / ntfy / TTS publishing (today it routes through n8n).

→ **Shared co-parent sheet.** One household sheet both parents edit in plain English — sizes, appts, behavior plans — to balance the invisible load.

→ **Sharper learning.** Per-situation time drift, learned channel response, tuned quiet hours.

→ **Live lock-screen timer.** A real countdown for an active outing, in the Dynamic Island.

⚙️ UNDER THE HOOD — FOR THE CURIOUS

A system of small, single-purpose agents over a **local SQLite behavioral memory** — the core everything learns into. **Capture** → **triage** → **memory** → **coaching** → **delivery**. A **coaching tick engine** asks each module "anything due?" and picks the channel; a **FastAPI** surface takes one-tap input from **iOS Shortcuts**; **n8n** orchestrates; **Ollama** runs inference on-device (optional **Claude** per task); reminders escalate over **Pushover** / **ntfy** / **TTS** with one-tap action buttons; everything's reachable over **Tailscale**, multi-user. Switch on only the ADHD modules that fit your profile.

Python 3.10+

FastAPI

SQLite

Ollama

Anthropic (optional)

n8n

iOS Shortcuts

Tailscale

ntfy / Pushover

MIT license

The modules

One executive-function challenge each — a primitive aimed at a specific dysfunction.

Switch on only what fits you
Each module is opt-in, per user
All five are live today

ADHD isn't one thing — so Prefrontal isn't one nudge.

Executive function fails in distinct ways: you lose the feel of time, you can't start, you can't stop, you switch on impulse. Each module targets *one* of those failure modes with its own trigger and its own intervention — built on the same shared behavioral memory, so they learn together.

Why split it up?

A single "reminder" can't tell paralysis from hyperfocus. Naming the dysfunction lets each response be the right one.

LIVE shipping **SOON** planned

Time perception & estimation Time Blindness time_blindness	Difficulty sensing elapsed time and estimating duration — chronic underestimation of how long tasks and travel really take, and departures that slip late. HOW IT SHOWS UP "Five more minutes" becomes forty; you leave for the 2:45 appointment at 2:40 because it feels close. WHAT PREFRONTAL DOES Corrects your estimates from your real history, pads departures with a learned buffer, and calls out elapsed time mid-task SOON.
Task initiation Task Paralysis task_paralysis	Difficulty initiating tasks despite intent — the work stalls before it ever begins, especially when it's large or ambiguous. HOW IT SHOWS UP You know exactly what to do and still can't start; the draft sits open, untouched, for an hour. WHAT PREFRONTAL DOES Shrinks it to a 5-minute first step, auto-decomposes the big/vague thing into moves, and offers a body-double check-in.
Focus regulation Hyperfocus hyperfocus	Intense sustained focus — a strength when aimed right, a liability when misdirected or when it overruns basic needs and commitments. HOW IT SHOWS UP Three hours into a side rabbit-hole; the real deadline and lunch both slid by unnoticed. WHAT PREFRONTAL DOES Protects the window when focus is on-target, checks alignment when it may be off, enforces biological breaks, and auto-closes abandoned sessions.
Response inhibition Impulsivity impulsivity	Acting before reflecting — abrupt context switches and snap decisions that pull attention off the intended task. HOW IT SHOWS UP A ping pulls you into a new tab, then a chore, then something else — the original task never comes back. WHAT PREFRONTAL DOES Inserts a reflective pause before a snap switch, captures the distraction to defer it, and surfaces your switch rate SOON.
Prospective memory, out in the world Location-Aware Task Anchor location_anchor	Leaving with a short, stated intention and losing track of time in the field — errands that quietly stretch well past when you meant to be back. HOW IT SHOWS UP "Just running to the store" turns into a two-hour loop of unplanned stops. WHAT PREFRONTAL DOES Escalating field nudges — soft at your stated time, firm when you're over, a voice call if you go far past — all gated by actually being on-site.

Same primitive, five aims — **each module names the dysfunction it treats.**

Opt-in per user • shared memory • learns which nudge works for you